



STATUS REPORT

Gambia: status report

Edition of 2026-08-27 · 68 systems and instruments tracked

Compiled 2026-08-27 by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository, from [outputs/reports/GMB/Ledger.csv](#) (68 systems and instruments, 13 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

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Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

The Gambia's identity and payment spines both entered service inside twelve months. The [National Identity Management System launched on 1 July 2026](#), issuing instant GAM ID cards from a state data centre opened the same day, with nationwide enrolment from 4 August 2026; no enrolment figure has been published since. Payments clear through [BANTABA 2.0, launched by the Central Bank on 15 December 2025](#).

The country has a data-protection statute and no visible regulator. The [Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act was enacted in 2025](#) with extraterritorial scope and an independent Commission provided for; nothing held states whether that Commission has been constituted.

The most specific claim the state makes for its own digitalisation is fiscal. The finance minister reported tax collected rising [from D11 billion in 2022 to D25 billion in 2025](#) and attributed it to digitalisation of collection rather than to rate rises — an attribution by the collecting side rather than an evaluation of it.

Two questions about foreign operators are open: [Starlink is still unlicensed](#) after a refusal stated in May 2026, and 80% of the state mobile operator [passed to YCELL on 9 July 2026](#).

Governance

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Cybersecurity Strategy and Action Plan 2022-2026	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Revised edition published, superseding the Proposed Formulation and Action Plan of July 2016
National Data Policy 2025	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft published by the communications ministry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Digital Economy Master Plan 2024-2034	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Adopted for the period 2024 to 2034
National Digital Identity Strategy 2023-2028	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Validated at a UN Economic Commission for Africa-supported workshop, 17 May 2024

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Access to Information Act	IMPLEMENTED, LARGELY UNIMPLEMENTED IN PRACTICE ↗	Press union reported implementation ineffective 2026-08-07
Broadcasting and Online Content Regulations, 2026	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft issued for public consultation 2026-04-02; child-protection provisions set out by the information minister 2026-08-16
Communications Bill 2025	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Sitting with National Assembly committees after second reading on 2 March 2026
State Intelligence Service Bill	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft validated at a stakeholder workshop, 31 July 2026

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Information Commission	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Communication-strategy support agreed 2026-08-17
Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Enacted, ending a legislative process stalled for several years
Data Protection and Privacy Commission	NOT HELD	—
Legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country	NOT HELD	—

Regional collaboration

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ATAF Heads of Tax Administrations Master Class	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Seventh Master Class convened in Banjul, 23-24 July 2026
Senegal-Gambia regulatory cooperation and free roaming agreement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed between the two regulators, June 2026
Senegal-Gambia digital cooperation memorandum	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Moved into implementation on four priorities

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Public participation in digital policymaking	NOT HELD	—

The law is in force and its regulator is not on record. The [Personal Data Protection and Privacy Act 2025](#) ends a legislative process stalled for several years: extraterritorial jurisdiction, seven lawful bases, a prohibition on processing genetic, biometric, health, racial and political data absent a lawful basis and a specific condition, and rights of access, rectification, erasure, objection and protection from solely automated decisions. It provides for an independent Commission. Nothing held states whether that Commission has been constituted, staffed or funded.

Two further bills would complete the frame, and both are unfinished. The [Communications Bill 2025 passed second reading on 2 March 2026](#) and went to committee; it covers electronic communications, broadcasting, electronic commerce, electronic signatures, computer misuse and cybercrime in one instrument, and the Press Union [set out](#)

the media laws it wants repealed alongside it on 18 July 2026. The [State Intelligence Service Bill](#) was validated at a workshop reported 31 July 2026 and is reported to require judicial warrants and oversight for intrusive measures. Its text is not held and does not appear in the National Assembly's bills library, checked 2026-08-08, so those provisions are held as reported rather than as drafted.

Policy sits ahead of instruments. The [National Data Policy 2025](#) is still a draft with no adoption on record, and the [Master Plan 2024-2034](#) carries no mid-term review or costed plan. The [National Cybersecurity Strategy and Action Plan 2022-2026](#) runs out at end-2026; the bodies it designs, GM-CSIRT among them, are not evidenced as standing. Regional cooperation runs through Senegal: the two regulators [signed a cooperation and free-roaming agreement in June 2026](#) with no commencement date given.

Finance

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	NOT HELD	—

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AfDB digital government project	PLANNED ↗	Carried in the bank's own reporting as a pipeline operation
Gates Foundation payment system pilot	DISCONTINUED ↗	Recorded as closed in the funder's own reporting
WARDIP national allocation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$50m equivalent grant approved, 7 November 2023

External financing for the digital programme is concentrated in one operation and thin elsewhere. The World Bank's regional digital integration programme carries a [US\\$50m equivalent allocation for the Gambia, approved on 7 November 2023](#) inside a wider US\$293m regional operation; no disbursement figure, results framework or mid-term review has been published for the Gambian share. The same programme funds the [National Labour Digital Skill initiative at US\\$3.35m](#) against a target of 280 certified, with no completion figure published since. The [African Development Bank's digital government project remains at pipeline stage](#), at about US\$1m, and the [Gates Foundation's payment-system pilot has closed](#) with no evaluation held. The domestic side of the ledger is not visible at all: no appropriation act, budget speech or estimate showing the digital votes for the communications ministry, the regulator or the digital programme is held.

ICT Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gambia National Broadband Network (China Eximbank loan)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Arrears of US\$0.25m cleared, 19 June 2020
GAMTEL national broadband modernisation PPP	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	US\$50m partnership signed at Bijilo, announced 5 January 2026
Liberia-Gambia-Sierra Leone roaming agreement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the three administrations, February 2025
Starlink satellite service licence	IN DEVELOPMENT, LICENCE WITHHELD ↗	Minister of Digital Economy stated he had refused to approve the permit, 24 May 2026

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Data Centre, Abuko	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated by President Barrow alongside the national identity system, 1 July 2026
QGroup House data centre	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Inaugurated by President Barrow, 30 April 2026

Energy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Power supply to the national digital estate	NOT HELD	—

Technical Capacity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital systems	NOT HELD	—

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National cybersecurity agency or incident response team	PLANNED, NO EVIDENCE OF OPERATION HELD ↗	GM-CSIRT named as the national incident response team in the National Cybersecurity Strategy and Action Plan 2022-2026

Hosting arrived in 2026, in two facilities ten weeks apart. [QGroup House, the first data centre, was inaugurated on 30 April 2026](#), built by QGroup and QCell with Huawei as vendor, and the state's [National Data Centre at Abuko opened on 1 July 2026](#) carrying the national identity system. Neither facility's capacity, tier rating nor operating cost is published, and nothing states who operates them.

The backbone is under a modernisation contract and not yet modernised. GAMTEL signed a [US\\$50m partnership with SYSROAD, announced 5 January 2026, to take national capacity from 40 Gbps to 800 Gbps](#); no completion date or milestone schedule accompanies it. The network it upgrades was built on a [US\\$25.9m China Eximbank concessional loan whose servicing fell into arrears](#), repayable by GAMTEL and collateralised against an escrow balance the lender can reach; nothing published since 2020 states the network's condition, utilisation or debt position.

Satellite access is unresolved. The Minister of Digital Economy said on [24 May 2026 that he had refused to approve Starlink's permit](#), on the ground that the operator lacked the competencies and equipment for a VSAT permit and required a general satellite licence instead. An analyst [argued in February 2026 for data-localisation and lawful-interception conditions](#) before any approval; no such conditions appear in an adopted instrument.

DPI

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gambia-Senegal customs data exchange roadmap	PLANNED ↗	Three-month roadmap agreed at the second Monitoring Committee, Saly, 16-17 July 2026
National Enterprise Architecture	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Framework validated under the ITU GovStack initiative, 22 May 2026

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Margins ID national identity contract	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Signed by the Ministry of Interior with Margins ID Systems Applications, 21 January 2026
National Identity Management System (GAM ID)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Nationwide rollout of ten-year biometric cards launched 2026-08-07 at six centres

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
BANTABA 2.0 instant payment system	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched by the Central Bank and the communications ministry, 15 December 2025
SUTURA government revenue collection integration	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed with the Office of the Accountant General, reported 20 July 2026
UNDP-FreedomPay Wallet blockchain payment distribution pilot	PILOTING ↗	Named among UNDP blockchain-based payment-distribution pilots cutting distribution costs from about 10% to as little as 2%, reported at a Paris meeting on Scaling Blockchain for Public Good, 2026-08-06
Wave-GTSC public transport fare payment	PLANNED ↗	Partnership signed for mobile-money bus fares, 20 June 2025
Yonna Wallet government payment collection	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Authorised by the Accountant General to collect all government-service payments, 2 March 2026

Registries

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Electronic civil registration and vital statistics	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Mass birth-registration and health-insurance campaign reached about 1.17m people
Gambia Social Registry	IMPLEMENTED ↗	203,022 households registered across 40 of 43 districts in two years
National Land Administration System and Land Information System	PLANNED ↗	Mandated by the National Land Policy 2026-2035, published 2026-08-12

Sectoral management information systems

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
DHIS2 for Education	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Study tour documenting the build, May 2026
Smart Paper Technology for community health data	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In use for community health data capture, December 2025

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil servant and pensioner verification exercise	IMPLEMENTED, PROVINCIAL ROUND SUSPENDED ↗	Up-country round suspended 2026-08-17
Community policing case management and facility mapping	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Programme documented from Essau to Gambisara, March 2026
Digital excise tax stamp	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In operation; study visits by South African and Rwandan customs announced 30 July 2026
Digital Single Window Business Registration System	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Trade minister stated the system is being finalised, 4 August 2026
Digitalisation of police records	PLANNED ↗	Inspector General directed the transition from paper to digital records, 24 March 2026

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Election digitalisation for the December 2026 polls	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Independent Electoral Commission announced partial digitalisation, 12 March 2026
GRA digital tax invoicing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched with Avatar Technologies, 9 July 2025
Integrated Financial Management Information System	IMPLEMENTED ↗	World Bank additional financing closed after rollout to further ministries
Integrated Tax Administration System	PLANNED ↗	Named as planned for electronic filing in the finance minister's reform account, 30 July 2026
National Digital Addressing rollout	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Steering committee launched, 13 October 2025

Identity is the spine, and it changed hands in January 2026. Card production moved from a foreign concession to an [eight-year build-operate-transfer contract with Margins ID](#) carrying a 70/30 revenue share and a phase-2 data centre, with [ten-year card validity](#). No contract value is published. Underneath sits the electronic civil registration system, which [registered about 1.17m people with a unique identification number](#) and remains the interoperability backbone; the [June 2025 commitment to integrate it with cards and the passport](#) has produced no published milestone. The [social registry stands at 203,022 households across 40 of 43 districts](#), unchanged since April 2024.

Payments are interoperable at the switch and plural at the front. [BANTABA 2.0 clears in real time across banks, mobile money, microfinance institutions and fintechs](#). Government collection runs through three separate arrangements: [Yonna Wallet, authorised on 2 March 2026](#), the [SUTURA platform wired in by memorandum in July 2026](#), and the revenue authority's [tax invoicing, live since 9 July 2025](#). None publishes a transaction volume or a fee structure. Separately, UNDP is [piloting blockchain-based payment distribution with FreedomPay Wallet](#), grouped with pilots in Haiti, Syria, Kenya and Guatemala said to cut distribution costs from about 10% to as little as 2%; no Gambia-specific volume or beneficiary count is published.

Tax administration is where the state's digitalisation claim is loudest and least verifiable. The [digital excise tax stamp is studied by five African revenue administrations](#), and the authority attaches to it a claimed 95% reduction in smuggling of excisable goods, for which it gives no method and which no independent party has verified.

Interoperability has a blueprint and no adoption: the [National Enterprise Architecture was validated under GovStack on 22 May 2026](#) and is not adopted, funded or implemented. Where exchange does run, it runs through customs — the [three-month roadmap agreed with Senegal on 16-17 July 2026](#) is the most operationally specific data-sharing commitment the base holds.

Statistics are the most complete system in the stack. The [fifth labour force survey was disseminated in July 2026](#) with [the first comparison across three rounds](#). Both volumes are donor-financed and no domestic budget line for the series is established.

Digitalisation

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Kanifing municipal digital addressing	IMPLEMENTED ↗	36,000 properties georeferenced with Plus Codes

Rural digital data capture

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Rural digital data capture	NOT HELD	—

Technology

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National artificial intelligence policy or strategy	NOT HELD	—

ICT Industry

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
GAMCEL 80% share sale and network modernisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Share Investment and Network Modernization Agreement signed, 9 July 2026

Innovation ecosystem

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gambia Digital Innovation Sprint	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Youth showcase held, 9 July 2026
Kalp Foundation Gambia One blockchain platform	PLANNED ↗	Memorandum signed, January 2025

Nothing in the base establishes an artificial-intelligence position for The Gambia — no policy, no strategy, no readiness assessment and no ministerial statement.

The technology-sector position is the disposal of the state mobile operator. Government [told lawmakers in December 2025](#) that YCELL had bid D6.7 billion for 80% of GAMCEL, and the [agreement signed on 9 July 2026](#) carries a [GMD 6.1 billion modernisation commitment](#) covering 4G and 5G radio access, core, operations and billing systems, hybrid tower power and revenue assurance. The base does not reconcile the two figures, and no post-transaction financial position for either operator is published.

One announced platform has produced nothing. A [memorandum with the Kalp Foundation for a blockchain-based Gambia One platform was signed in January 2025](#); nineteen months later nothing held records a build, a pilot, funding or a withdrawal. The other innovation activity on record is a [youth showcase on 9 July 2026](#), with no follow-on funding.

Capacity

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Rural women and girls digital rights programme	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Eight workshops delivered between September 2025 and March 2026, reported 30 July 2026

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National Labour Digital Skill programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Methodology and report validated, 23 December 2025

Inclusion

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Affordability of internet access	NOT HELD	—

Skills work is small. The [National Labour Digital Skill methodology was validated on 23 December 2025](#) against a target of 280 certified, with no completion figure since. A [digital rights programme trained 400 women and girls across four regions](#) between September 2025 and March 2026, and its implementer names unreliable internet, high data costs and unreliable electricity as the obstacles to continued practice — the closest thing the base holds to a demand-side account of access.

On access itself there is no domestic measure. DataReportal's commercial compilation [put internet users at 45.9% of the population in March 2025](#); no domestic price basket, affordability survey or regulator tariff series is held against it.

Data

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Coordination of official statistics production	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Central Bank convened producers and users, 22 July 2026
Gambia Labour Force Survey series	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Fifth round disseminated at Bakau with a first three-round trend volume, July 2026

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National open-data portal	NOT HELD	—

Geopolitics

EU activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
European Union digital cooperation with The Gambia	NOT HELD	—

Gulf/UAE activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Gulf state digital investment in The Gambia	NOT HELD	—

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Indian digital cooperation with The Gambia	NOT HELD	—

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Power supply to the national digital estate	A generation, tariff or outage statement bearing on data-centre or network operation, or the power provision in either data centre's design.	not yet probed
Domestic technical capacity to operate the national digital systems	A staffing plan, skills audit or operations report covering who runs the National Data Centre, the identity system and the payment switch.	not yet probed
Rural digital data capture	An agricultural, land or extension data-collection programme, or a rural administration digital plan. The health and social registry systems are the only field data capture on record.	not yet probed
Data Protection and Privacy Commission	A commencement instrument, an appointment notice, a budget line or a first annual report. The Act provides for an independent Commission; nothing held states whether it has been constituted.	2026-08-09
Legal basis for issuing identity cards outside the country	An official response, a regulation or a registry statement covering issuance in Mauritania, Congo and Togo, which the opposition alleged was unlawful in August 2025.	not yet probed
National open-data portal	A published portal, dataset catalogue, or the text of the Open Data Strategy 2023-2026 the base refers to but does not hold.	not yet probed
Public participation in digital policymaking	A consultation register, a published submission round, or a civil-society account of participation in the data, communications or intelligence bills.	not yet probed
European Union digital cooperation with The Gambia	A Global Gateway announcement, an EU delegation programme document, or a financing agreement naming The Gambia.	not yet probed
National artificial intelligence policy or strategy	A policy, strategy, readiness assessment or ministerial statement on artificial intelligence. The only material bearing on The Gambia in the base is a continental data-protection roundup.	not yet probed
Indian digital cooperation with The Gambia	A bilateral memorandum, a line of credit, or an India Stack or technical cooperation programme document naming The Gambia.	not yet probed
Gulf state digital investment in The Gambia	An investment agreement, data-centre or connectivity commitment from a Gulf sovereign fund or operator.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriations for the digital sector	An appropriation act, budget speech or estimate showing the votes for the communications ministry, the regulator and the digital programme.	not yet probed
Affordability of internet access	A domestic price basket, an affordability survey, or a regulator tariff series. Penetration is held only from a commercial reference compilation.	not yet probed

Nine are areas the base holds nothing on: the power behind the digital estate, the capacity that runs it, rural data capture, open data, public participation, artificial intelligence, and European, Indian and Gulf cooperation.

The other four are objects the record points at and does not hold. The data-protection Commission is provided for in an enacted statute and appears nowhere else. The legal basis on which identity cards were issued in Mauritania, Congo and Togo was questioned by the opposition in August 2025 and has drawn no answer.

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